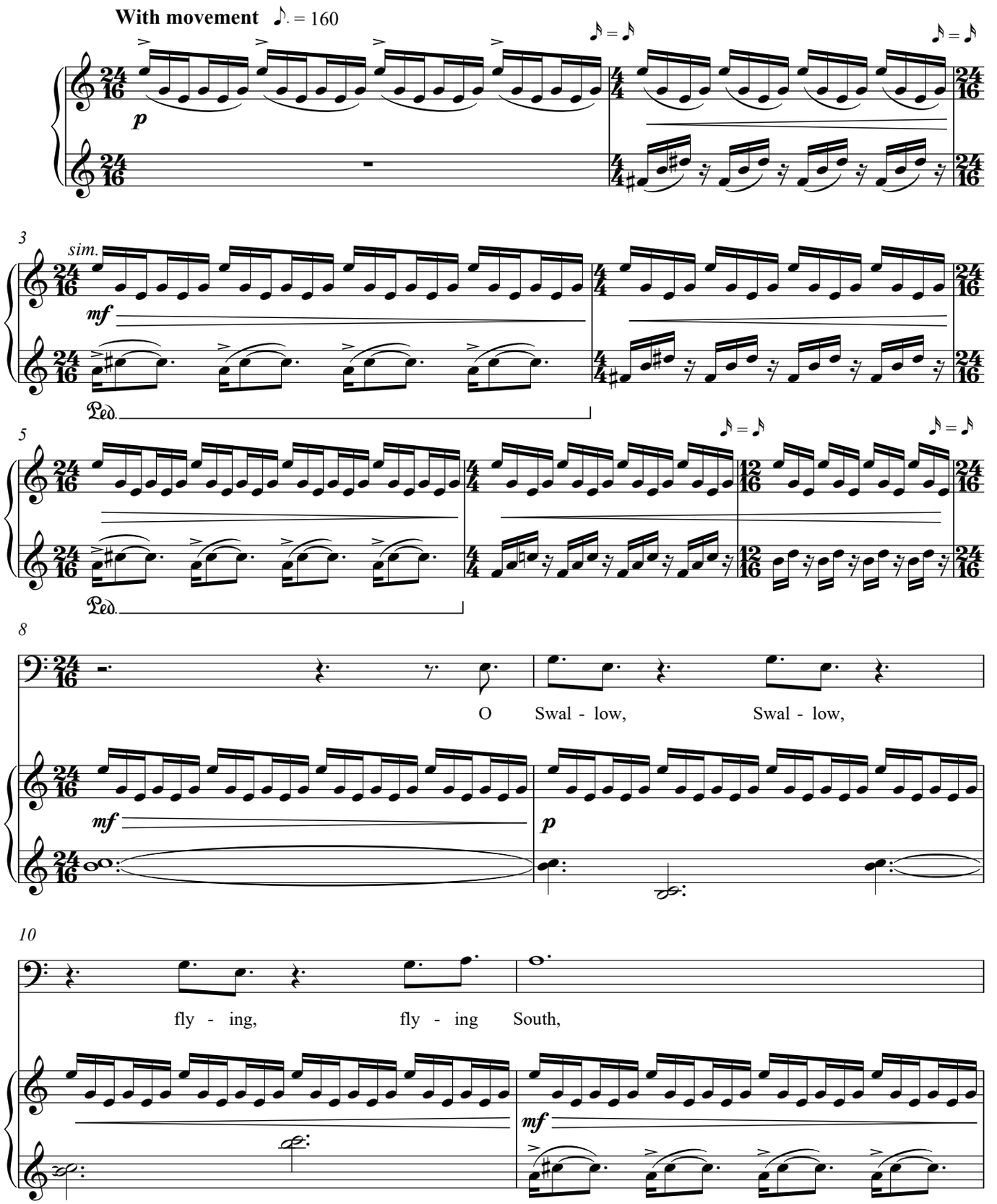to Philippe Sly

Three Tennyson Songs

1. O Swallow, Swallow

Alfred, Lord Tennyson

Jonathan Dove
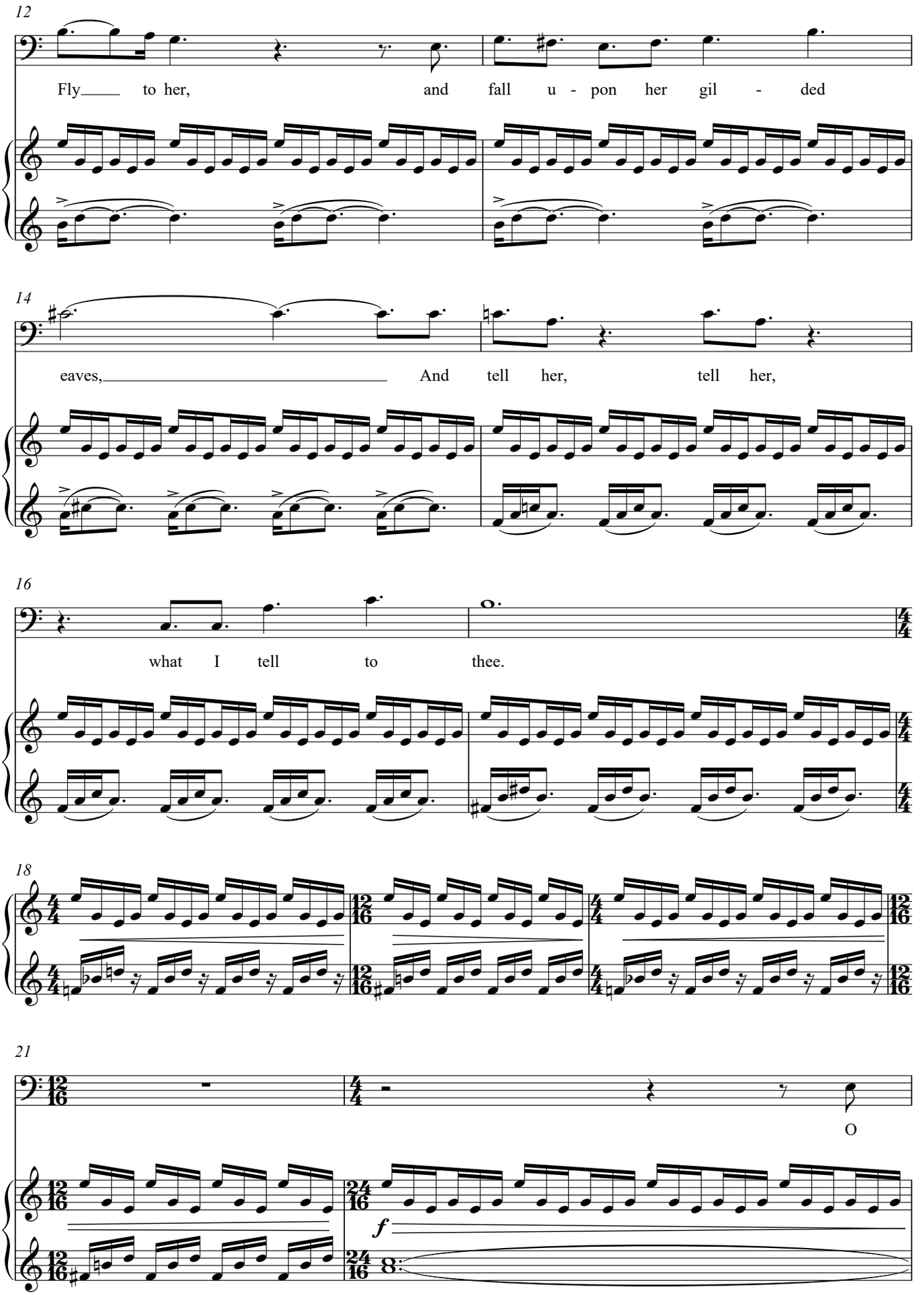


Edition Peters 72162

© 2010 by Peters Edition Ltd, London
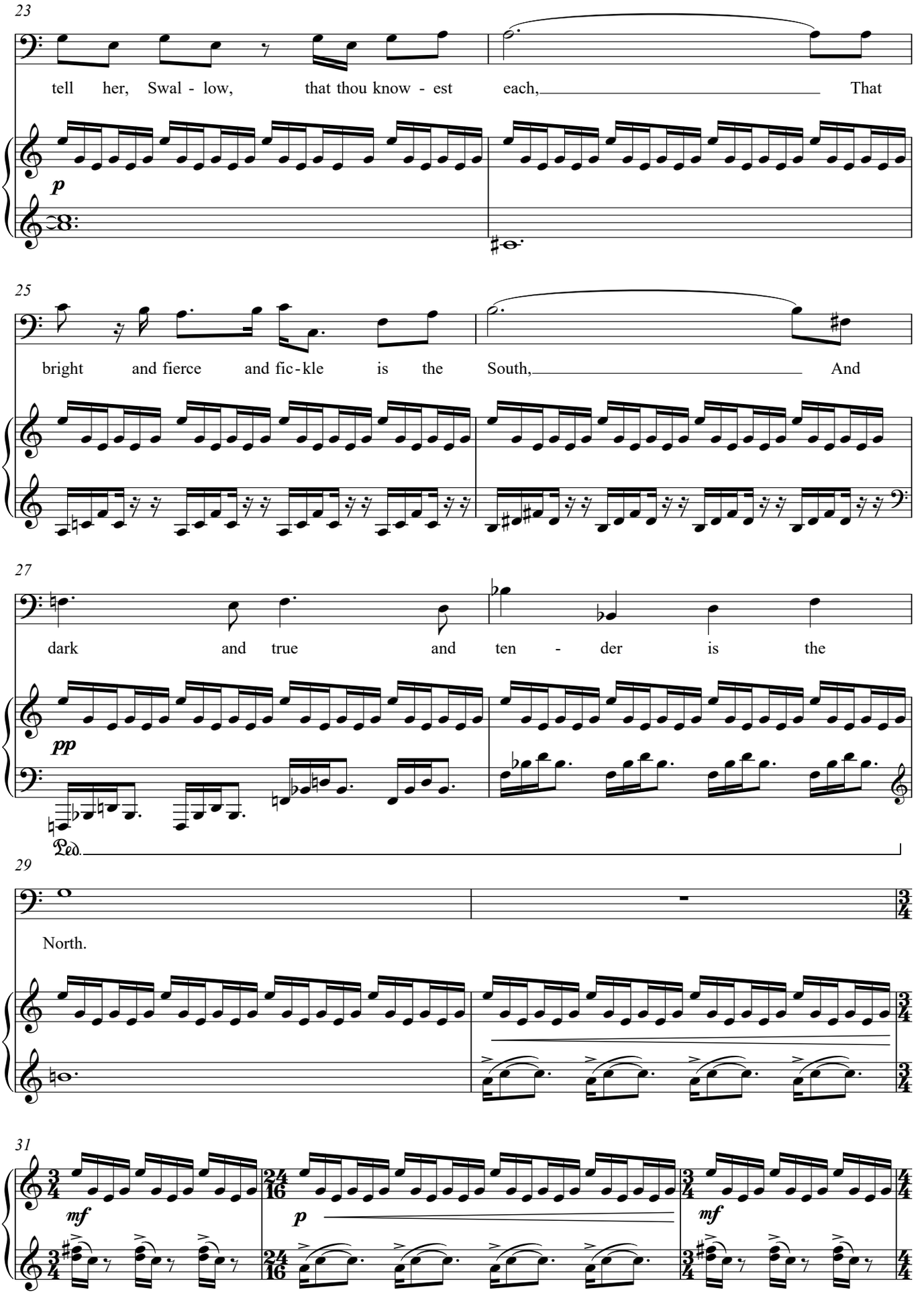
This music has been legally downloaded. Do not photocopy.

Faber Music Store - 1149093181 - 1 authorised copy purchased for private use by Maotong Yu on 15/03/2025 - Photocopying or digital distribution of any kind without a licence is prohibited.
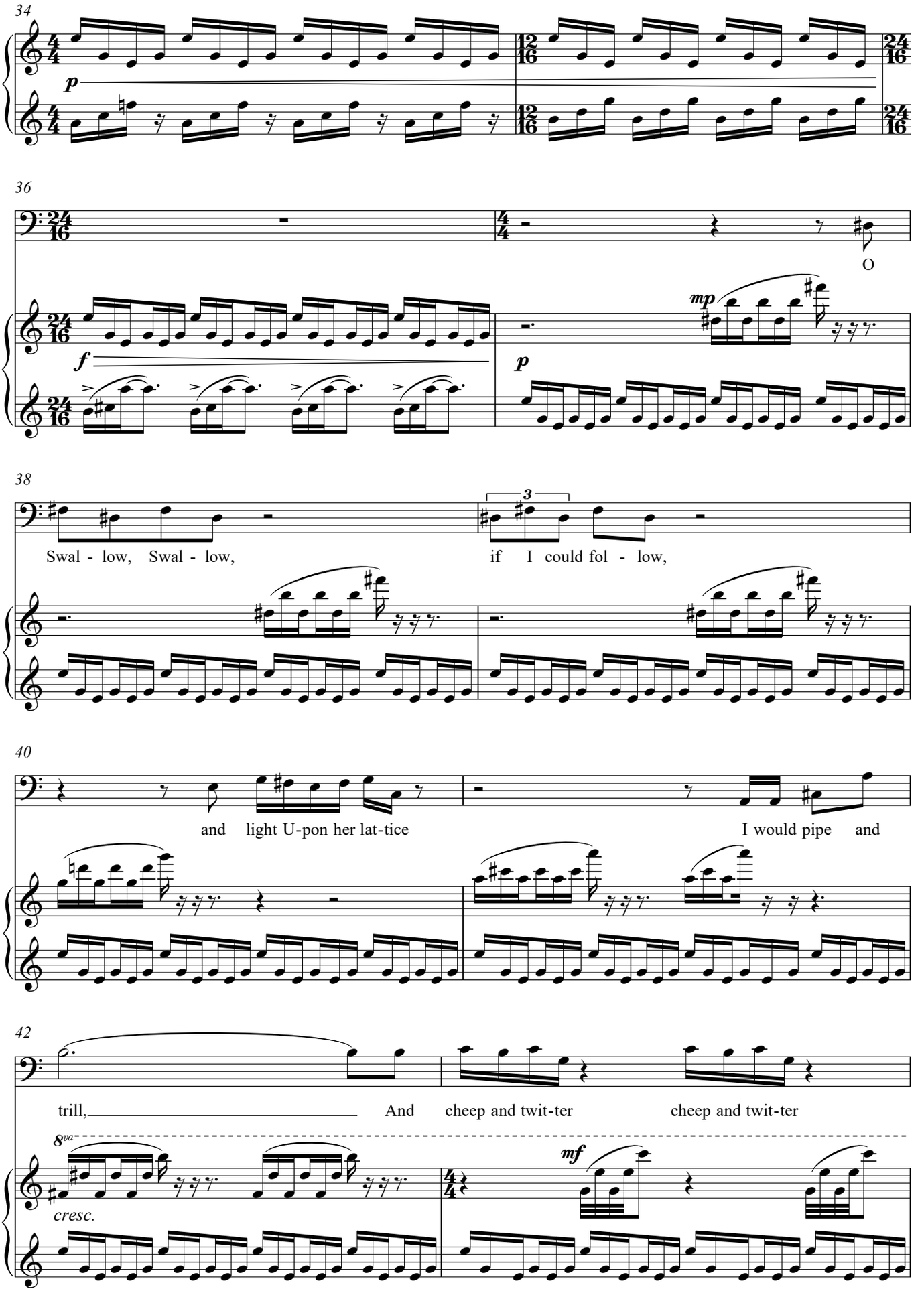


This music has been legally downloaded. Do not photocopy.

Faber Music Store - 1149093181 - 1 authorised copy purchased for private use by Maotong Yu on 15/03/2025 - Photocopying or digital distribution of any kind without a licence is prohibited.
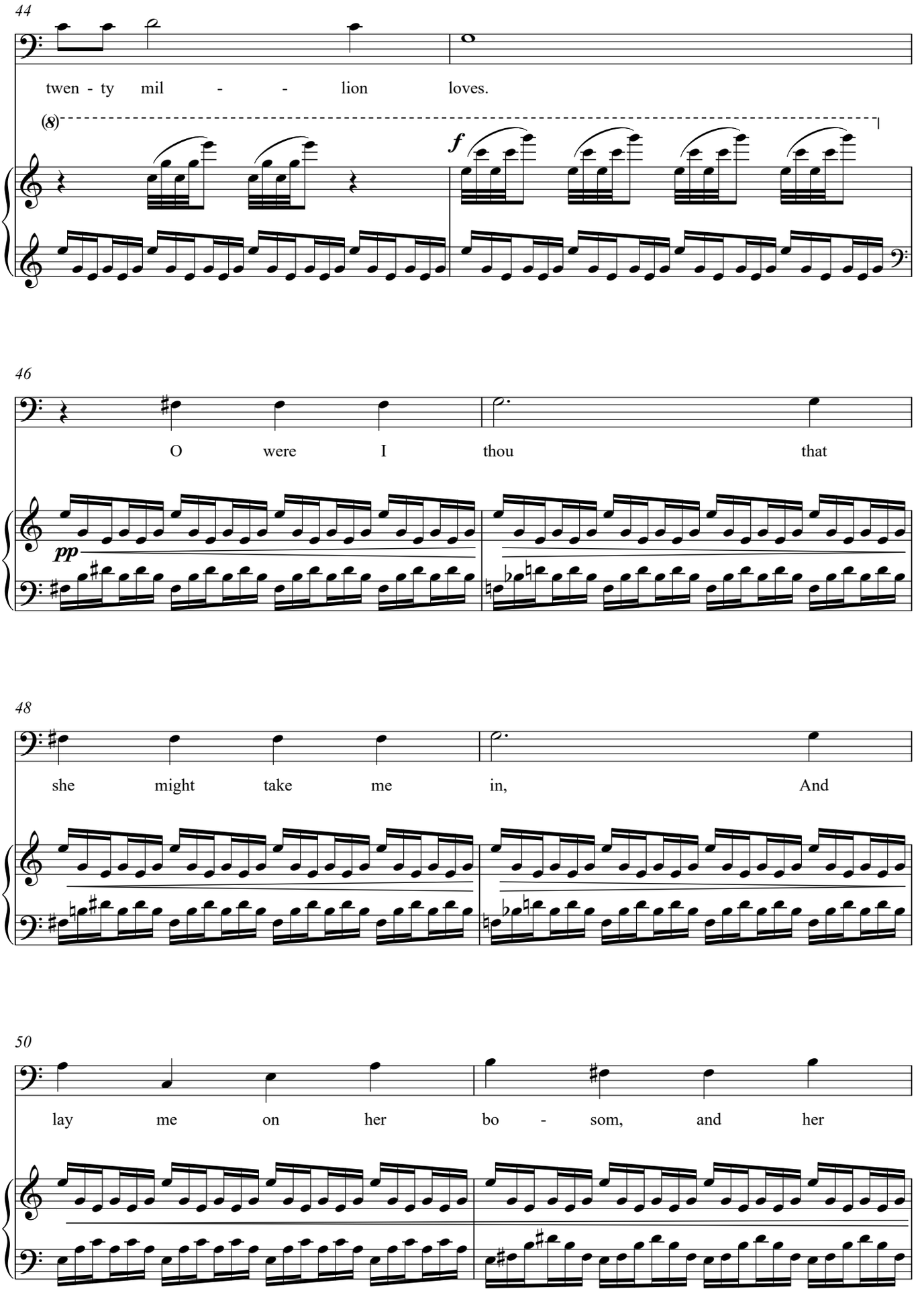


This music has been legally downloaded. Do not photocopy.

Faber Music Store - 1149093181 - 1 authorised copy purchased for private use by Maotong Yu on 15/03/2025 - Photocopying or digital distribution of any kind without a licence is prohibited.
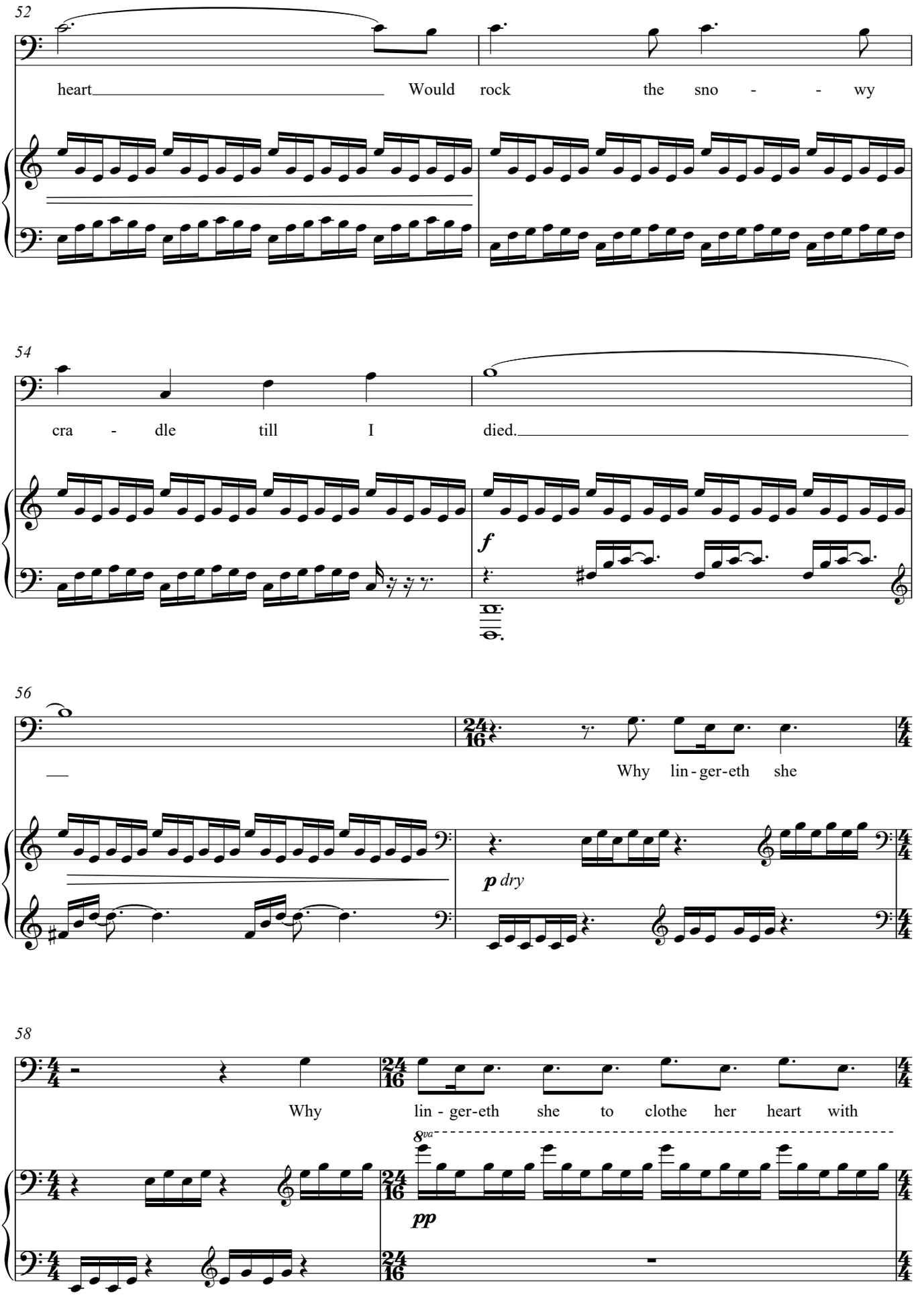


This music has been legally downloaded. Do not photocopy.

Faber Music Store - 1149093181 - 1 authorised copy purchased for private use by Maotong Yu on 15/03/2025 - Photocopying or digital distribution of any kind without a licence is prohibited.
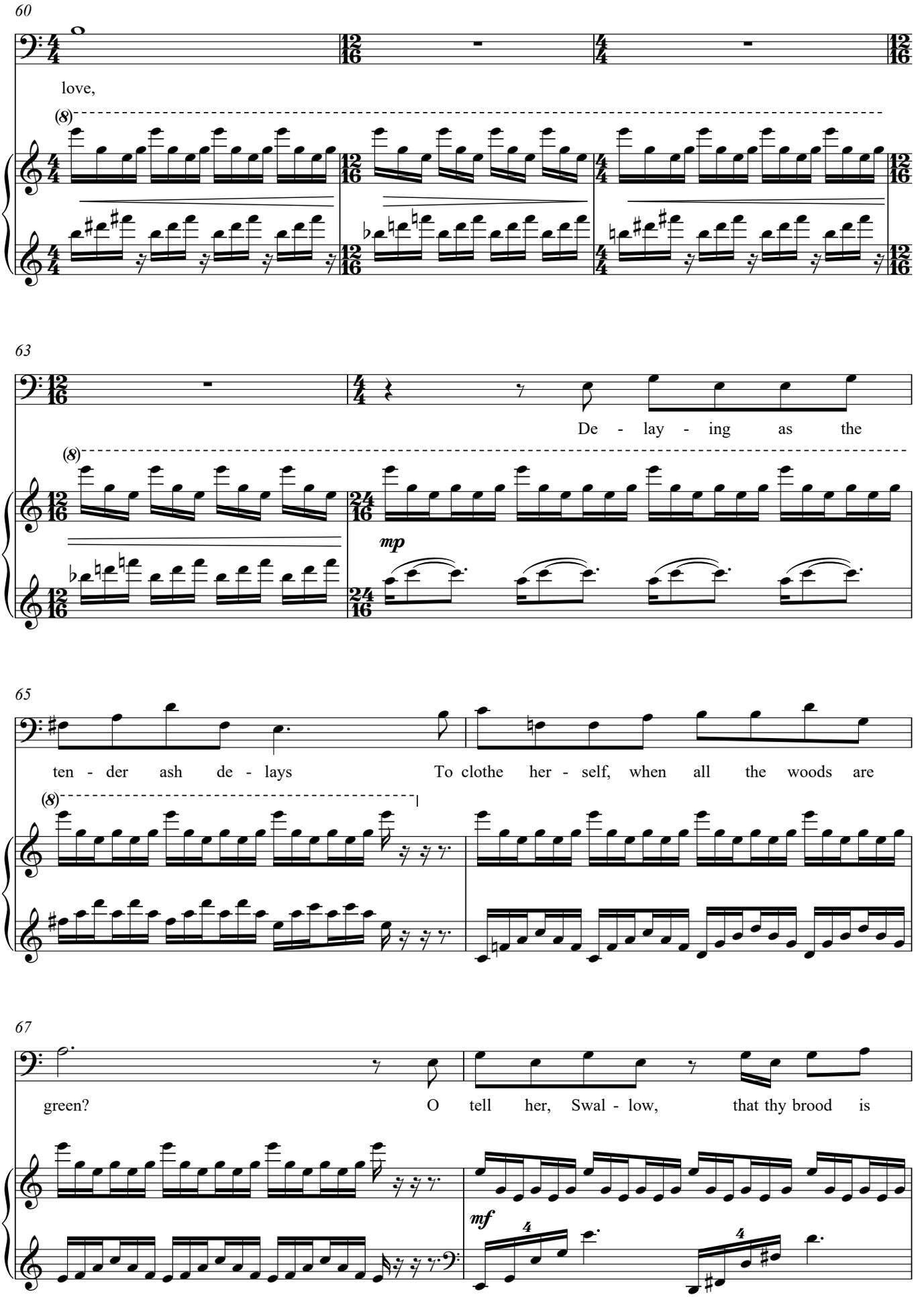


This music has been legally downloaded. Do not photocopy.

Faber Music Store - 1149093181 - 1 authorised copy purchased for private use by Maotong Yu on 15/03/2025 - Photocopying or digital distribution of any kind without a licence is prohibited.
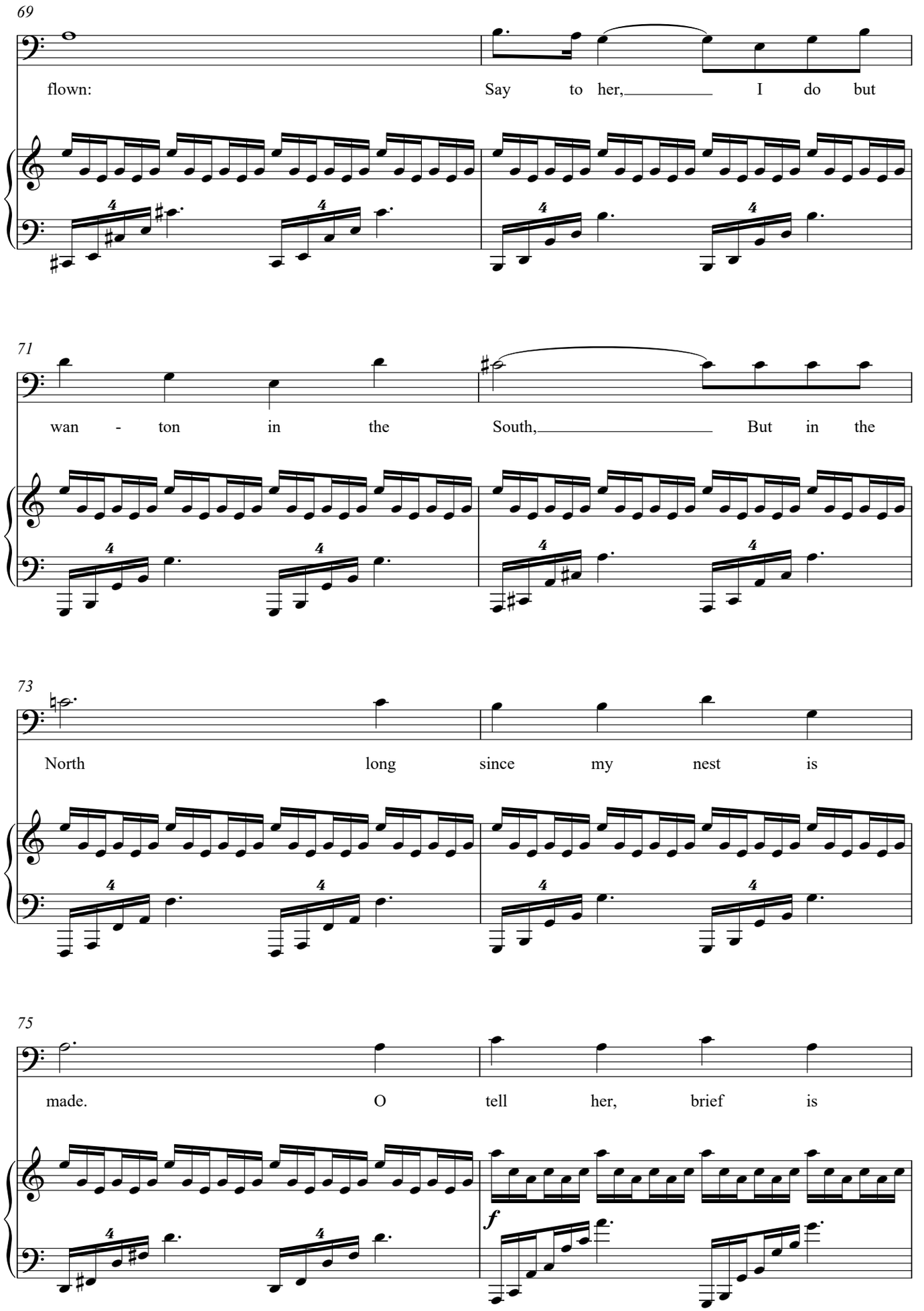


This music has been legally downloaded. Do not photocopy.

Faber Music Store - 1149093181 - 1 authorised copy purchased for private use by Maotong Yu on 15/03/2025 - Photocopying or digital distribution of any kind without a licence is prohibited.
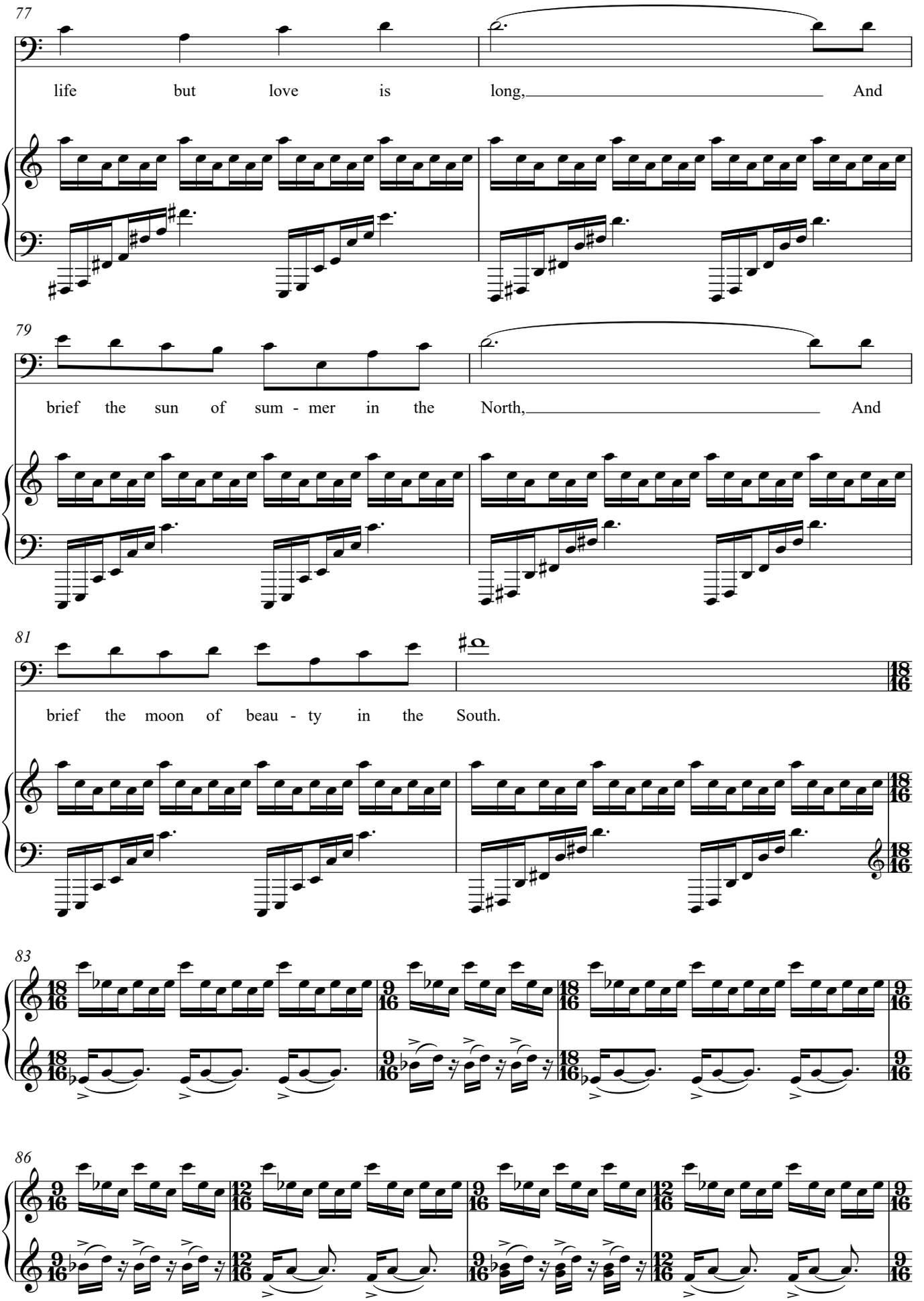


This music has been legally downloaded. Do not photocopy.

Faber Music Store - 1149093181 - 1 authorised copy purchased for private use by Maotong Yu on 15/03/2025 - Photocopying or digital distribution of any kind without a licence is prohibited.



This music has been legally downloaded. Do not photocopy.

Faber Music Store - 1149093181 - 1 authorised copy purchased for private use by Maotong Yu on 15/03/2025 - Photocopying or digital distribution of any kind without a licence is prohibited.



This music has been legally downloaded. Do not photocopy.

Faber Music Store - 1149093181 - 1 authorised copy purchased for private use by Maotong Yu on 15/03/2025 - Photocopying or digital distribution of any kind without a licence is prohibited.

90

92

O Swal - low, Swal - low, fly - ing

ff

Ped.

94
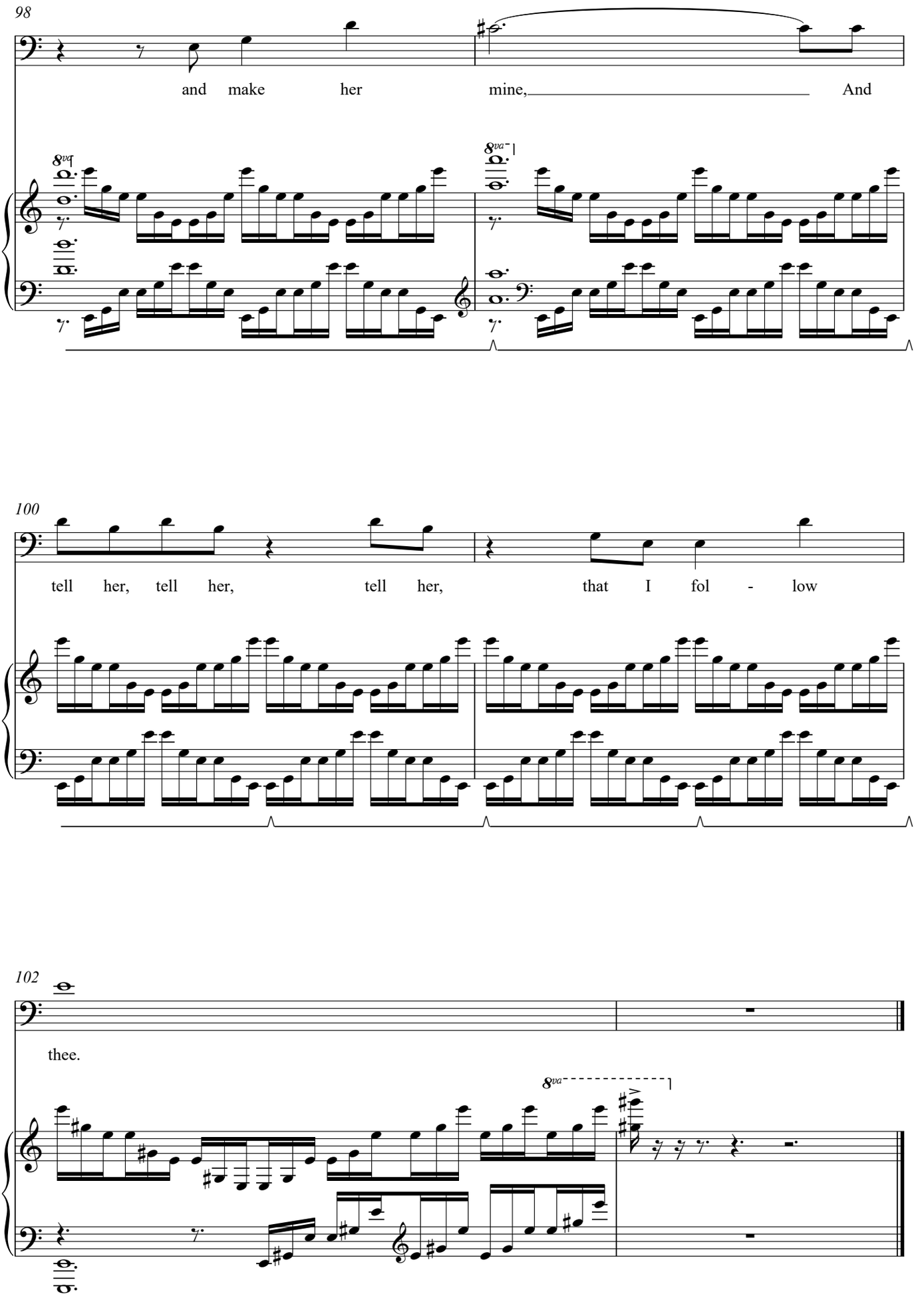
from the gol - den woods,

96

Fly to her, and pipe and woo her,

This music has been legally downloaded. Do not photocopy.
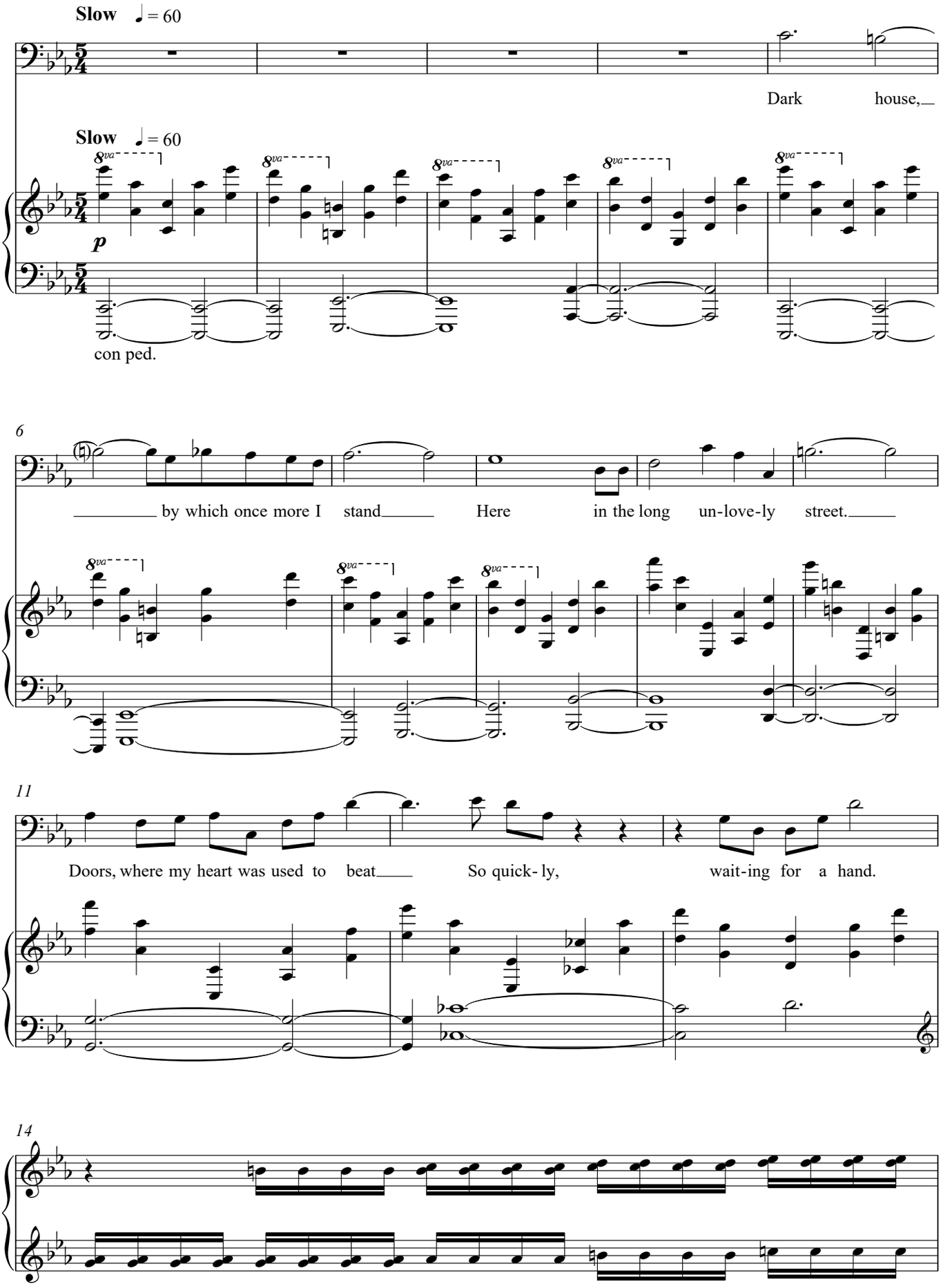
Faber Music Store - 1149093181 - 1 authorised copy purchased for private use by Maotong Yu on 15/03/2025 - Photocopying or digital distribution of any kind without a licence is prohibited.



This music has been legally downloaded. Do not photocopy.
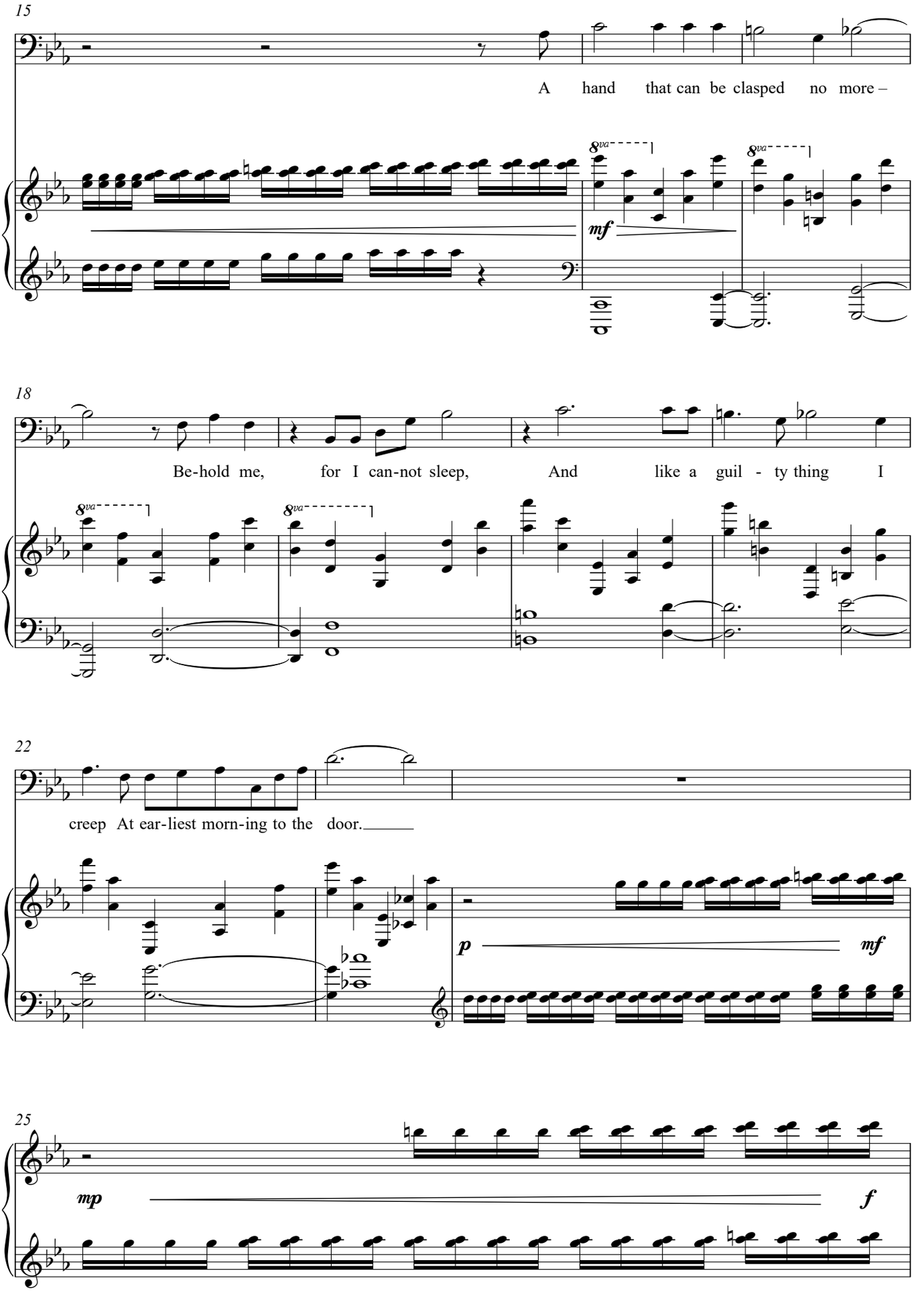
Faber Music Store - 1149093181 - 1 authorised copy purchased for private use by Maotong Yu on 15/03/2025 - Photocopying or digital distribution of any kind without a licence is prohibited.

2. Dark House
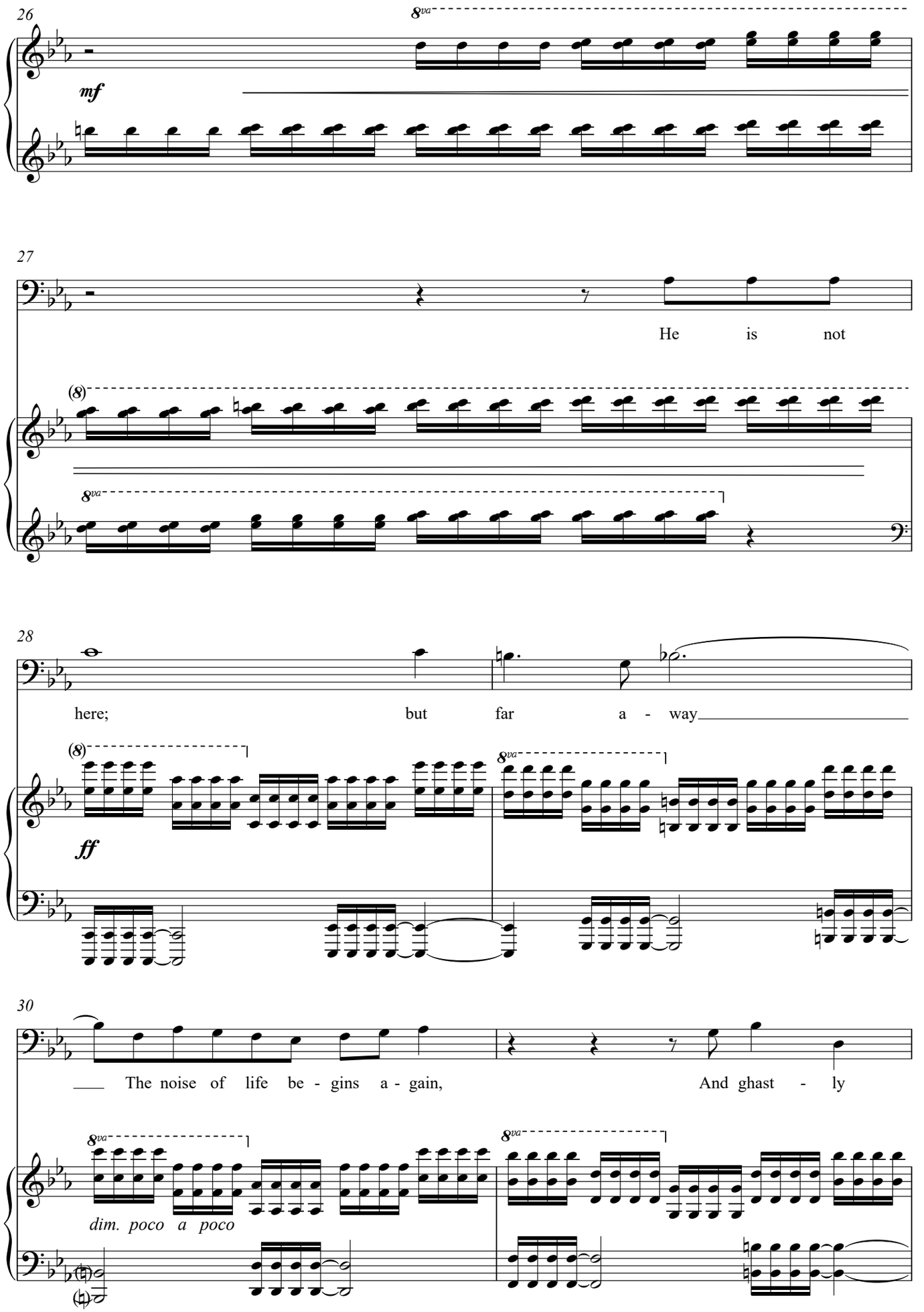


This music has been legally downloaded. Do not photocopy.

Faber Music Store - 1149093181 - 1 authorised copy purchased for private use by Maotong Yu on 15/03/2025 - Photocopying or digital distribution of any kind without a licence is prohibited.
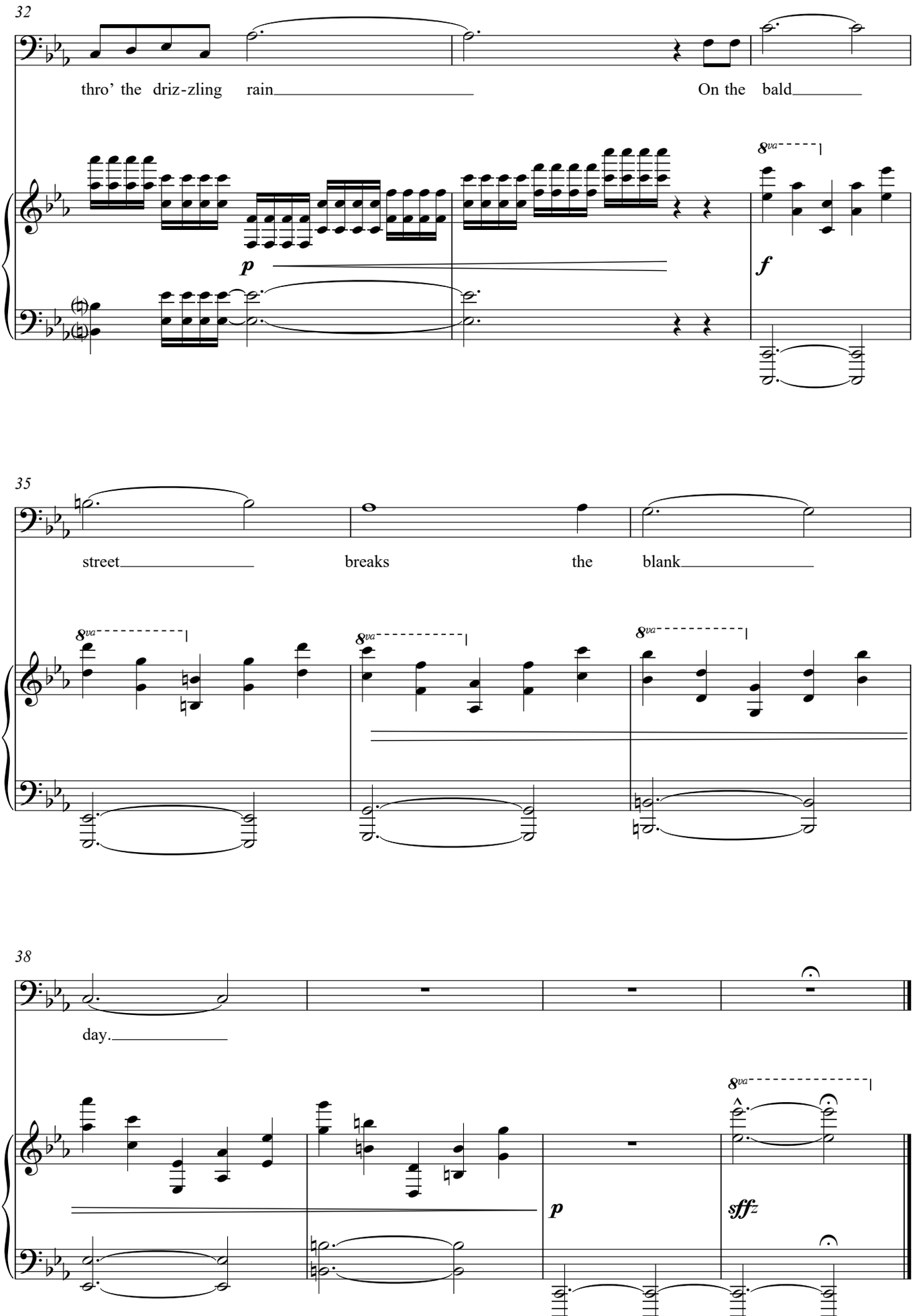


This music has been legally downloaded. Do not photocopy.

Faber Music Store - 1149093181 - 1 authorised copy purchased for private use by Maotong Yu on 15/03/2025 - Photocopying or digital distribution of any kind without a licence is prohibited.



This music has been legally downloaded. Do not photocopy.
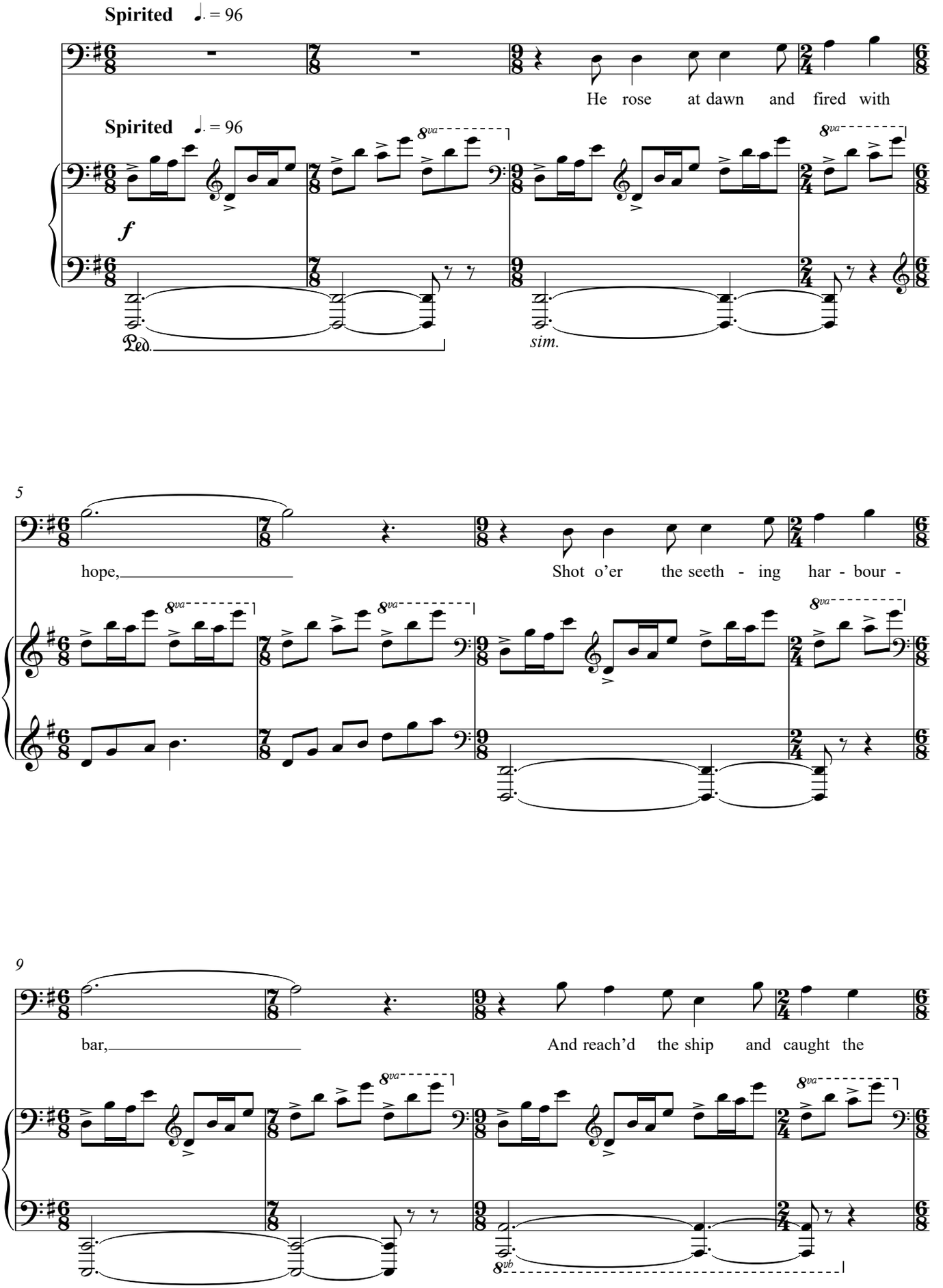
Faber Music Store - 1149093181 - 1 authorised copy purchased for private use by Maotong Yu on 15/03/2025 - Photocopying or digital distribution of any kind without a licence is prohibited.



This music has been legally downloaded. Do not photocopy.

Faber Music Store - 1149093181 - 1 authorised copy purchased for private use by Maotong Yu on 15/03/2025 - Photocopying or digital distribution of any kind without a licence is prohibited.

3. The Sailor-boy



This music has been legally downloaded. Do not photocopy.

Faber Music Store - 1149093181 - 1 authorised copy purchased for private use by Maotong Yu on 15/03/2025 - Photocopying or digital distribution of any kind without a licence is prohibited.

13

rope, And whis - tled to the morn - ing

17

star.

21

And while he whis - tled long and loud
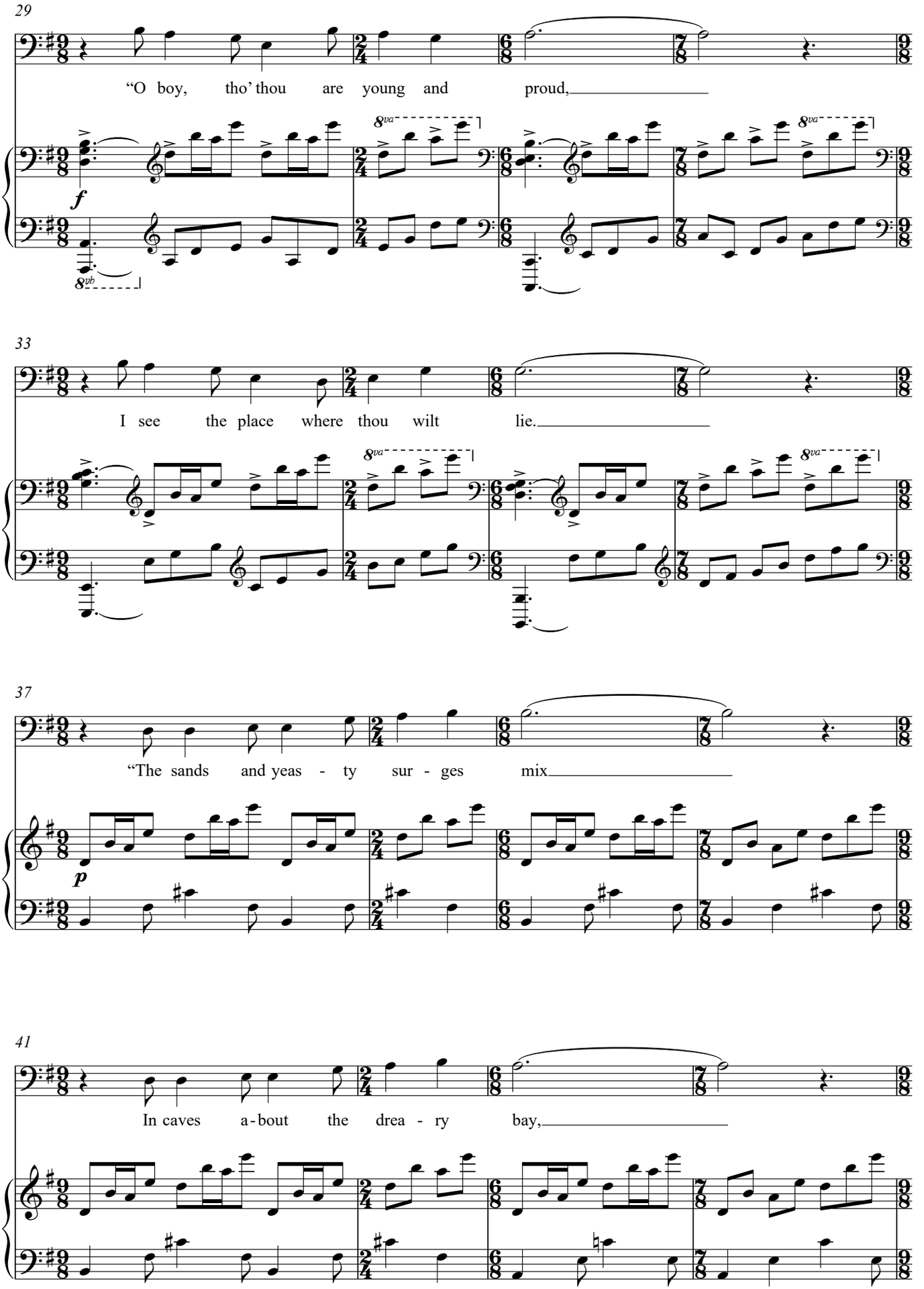
mp

25

He heard a fierce mer - mai - den cry,
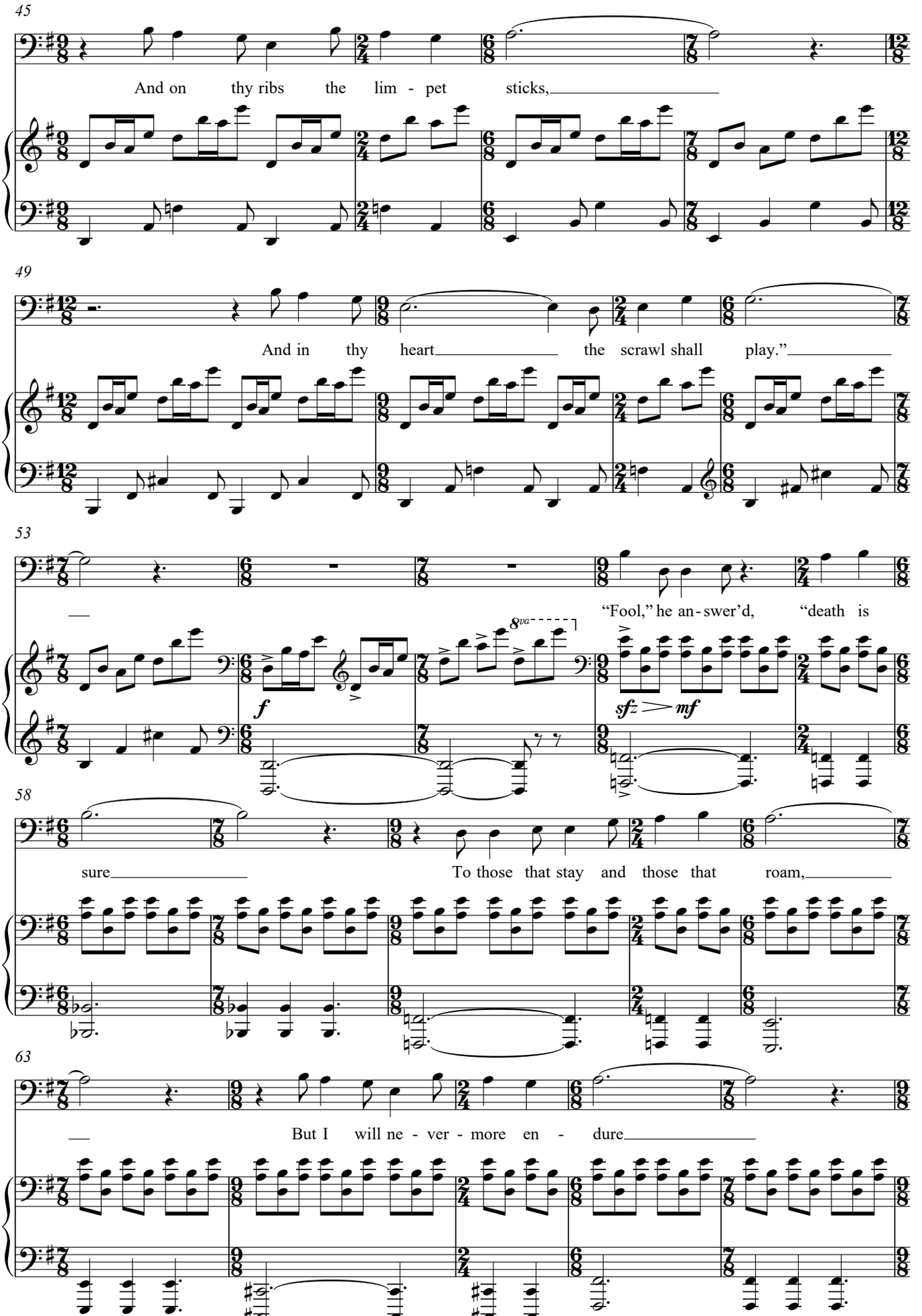
This music has been legally downloaded. Do not photocopy.

Faber Music Store - 1149093181 - 1 authorised copy purchased for private use by Maotong Yu on 15/03/2025 - Photocopying or digital distribution of any kind without a licence is prohibited.



This music has been legally downloaded. Do not photocopy.

Faber Music Store - 1149093181 - 1 authorised copy purchased for private use by Maotong Yu on 15/03/2025 - Photocopying or digital distribution of any kind without a licence is prohibited.



This music has been legally downloaded. Do not photocopy.

Faber Music Store - 1149093181 - 1 authorised copy purchased for private use by Maotong Yu on 15/03/2025 - Photocopying or digital distribution of any kind without a licence is prohibited.

68

To sit with emp - ty hands at home. "My mo - ther clings a-

73

bout my neck. My sis - ters cry - ing, "Stay for shame;"

79
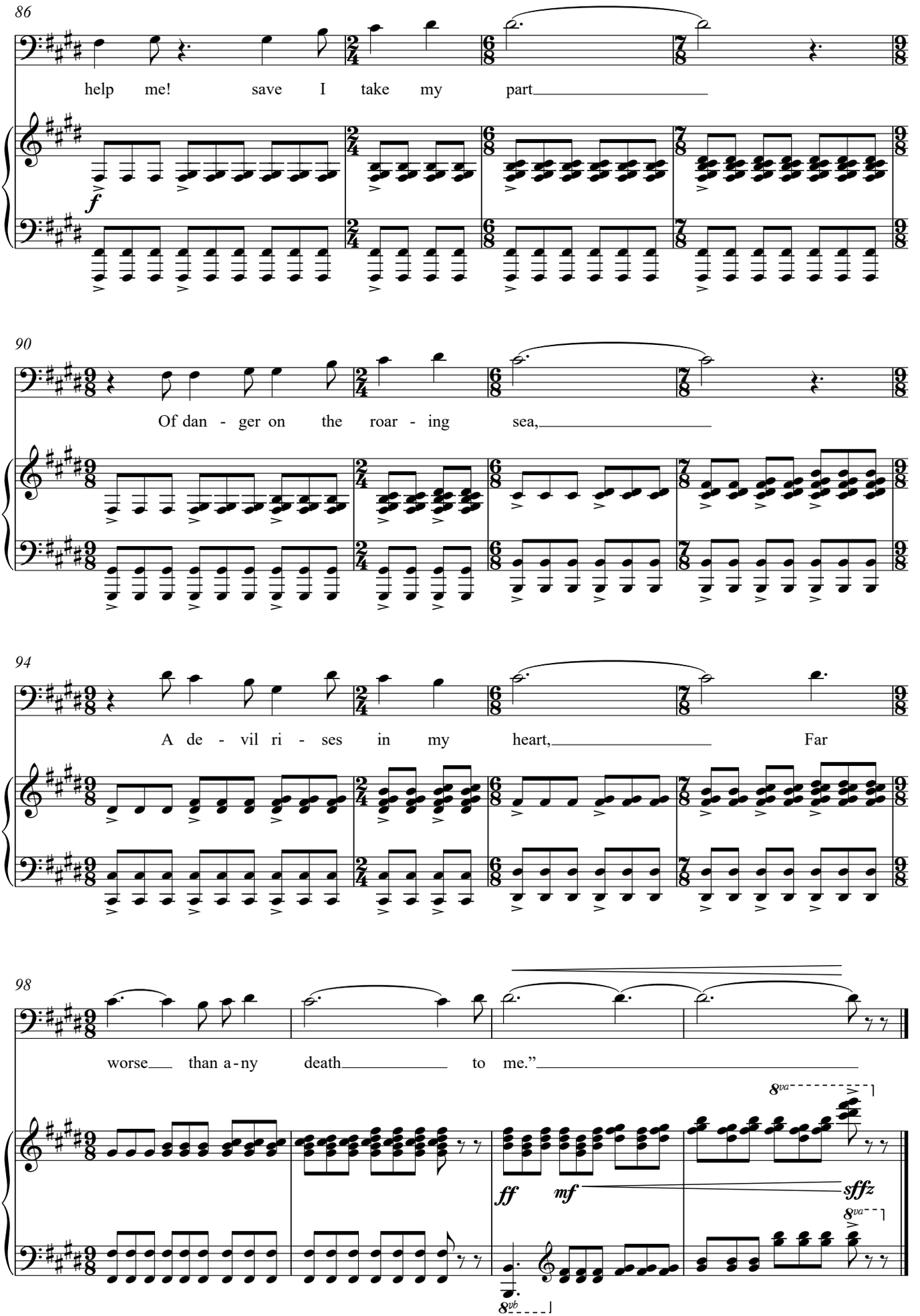
My fa - ther raves of death and wreck –

83

They are all to blame, they are all to blame. "God

This music has been legally downloaded. Do not photocopy.

Faber Music Store - 1149093181 - 1 authorised copy purchased for private use by Maotong Yu on 15/03/2025 - Photocopying or digital distribution of any kind without a licence is prohibited.



This music has been legally downloaded. Do not photocopy.

Faber Music Store - 1149093181 - 1 authorised copy purchased for private use by Maotong Yu on 15/03/2025 - Photocopying or digital distribution of any kind without a licence is prohibited.

1.
O Swallow, Swallow

O Swallow, Swallow, flying, flying South,
Fly to her, and fall upon her gilded eaves,
And tell her, tell her, what I tell to thee.

O tell her, Swallow, thou that knowest each,
That bright and fierce and fickle is the South,
And dark and true and tender is the North.

O Swallow, Swallow, if I could follow, and light
Upon her lattice, I would pipe and trill,
And cheep and twitter twenty million loves.

O were I thou that she might take me in,
And lay me on her bosom, and her heart
Would rock the snowy cradle till I died.

Why lingereth she to clothe her heart with love,
Delaying as the tender ash delays
To clothe herself, when all the woods are green?

O tell her, Swallow, that thy brood is flown:
Say to her, I do but wanton in the South,
But in the North long since my nest is made.

O tell her, brief is life but love is long,
And brief the sun of summer in the North,
And brief the moon of beauty in the South.

O Swallow, flying from the golden woods,
Fly to her, and pipe and woo her, and make her mine,
And tell her, tell her, that I follow thee.

2.
Dark House

Dark house, by which once more I stand
Here in the long unlovely street.
Doors, where my heart was used to beat
So quickly, waiting for a hand.

A hand that can be clasped no more –
Behold me, for I cannot sleep,
And like a guilty thing I creep
At earliest morning to the door.

He is not here; but far away
The noise of life begins again,
And ghastly thro' the drizzling rain
On the bald street breaks the blank day.

3.
The Sailor-boy

He rose at dawn and fired with hope,
Shot o'er the seething harbour-bar,
And reach'd the ship and caught the rope,
And whistled to the morning star.

And while he whistled long and loud
He heard a fierce mermaiden cry,
'O boy, tho' thou are young and proud,
I see the place where thou wilt lie.

'The sands and yeasty surges mix
In caves about the dreary bay,
And on thy ribs the limpet sticks,
And in thy heart the scrawl shall play.'

'Fool,' he answer'd, 'death is sure
To those that stay and those that roam,
But I will nevermore endure
To sit with empty hands at home.

'My mother clings about my neck,
My sisters crying, "Stay for shame;"
My father raves of death and wreck,-
They are all to blame, they are all to blame.

'God help me! save I take my part
Of danger on the roaring sea,
A devil rises in my heart,
Far worse than any death to me.'

Alfred, Lord Tennyson (1809-1892)

This music has been legally downloaded. Do not photocopy.

Faber Music Store - 1149093181 - 1 authorised copy purchased for private use by Maotong Yu on 15/03/2025 - Photocopying or digital distribution of any kind without a licence is prohibited.

Duration: *c.* 10 minutes

Dedicated to Philippe Sly

First performance by Philippe Sly (bass-baritone) and Esther Gonthier (pianist)

at McGill University (Montreal Quebec) in April 2011

This music has been legally downloaded. Do not photocopy.

Faber Music Store - 1149093181 - 1 authorised copy purchased for private use by Maotong Yu on 15/03/2025 - Photocopying or digital distribution of any kind without a licence is prohibited.